MILITARY SPECIFICATION

FORCEPS, EAR, House, Strut

This specification is approved for use within the Defense Personnel Support Center and is available for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers one size of strut implantation forceps of the House design for use in microscopic surgery of the ear.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Specifications and standards. The following specifications and standards form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents shall be those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DoDISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation.

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: Headquarters, Defense Personnel Support Center, ATTN: Directorate of Medical Materiel, DPSC-RST, 2800 S. 20th Street, Philadelphia, PA 19101, by using self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC N/A FSC 6515
DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T20:15Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

GG-I-526	- Instruments, Dental and Surgical; General Specification.
PPP-B-566	- Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-601	- Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood.
PPP-B-621	- Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.
PPP-B-636	- Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-676	- Boxes, Set-up.

MILITARY

MIL-P-116	- Preservation, Methods of.
MIL-L-19547	- Liners, Case and Sheet Overwrap; Water-Vaporproof or Waterproof, Flexible

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105	- Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129	- Marking for Shipment and Storage.
MIL-STD-147	- Palletized Unit Loads.
MIL-STD-794	- Parts and Equipment, Procedures for Packaging of.

2.1.2 Drawings. The following drawing forms a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issue shall be those in effect on the date of solicitation.

DPSC Drawing 24487 - FORCEPS, EAR, House, Strut, Extremely Delicate

(Copies of specifications and standards required by contractors in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting activity.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of the documents which are DoD adopted shall be those listed in the issue of the DoDISS specified in the solicitation. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of documents not listed in the DoDISS shall be the issue of the nongovernment documents which is current on the date of the solicitation.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T20:15Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS (ASTM) STANDARDS

E 18 - Rockwell Hardness and Rockwell Superficial Hardness of Metallic Materials, Tests for.

E 92 - Vickers Hardness of Metallic Materials, Tests for.

E 140 - Hardness Conversion Tables for Metals (Relationship Between Brinell Hardness, Vickers Hardness, Rockwell Hardness, Rockwell Superficial Hardness and Knoop Hardness).

F 899 - Stainless Steel Billet, Bar and Wire for Surgical Instruments.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race St., Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

(Nongovernment standards and other publications are normally available from the organizations which prepare or which distribute the documents. These documents also may be available in or through libraries or other informational services.)

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this specification and the references cited herein, the text of this specification shall take precedence. Nothing in this specification, however, shall supersede applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. Forceps shall be manufactured from Class 4 martensitic corrosion-resistant steel in accordance with ASTM F899.

3.2 Hardness. The forcep tips shall have a Rockwell hardness of C 48 to C 53. Forcep tips shall not vary in hardness by more than five points. Forceps shall be tested for hardness in accordance with 4.5.1.

3.3 Style and design. Forceps shall be of the dimensions and design of DPSC Drawing 24487. The top lever arm shall be capable of disengaging from the lever pivot for raising and cleaning. The pivot mechanism and lever guide shall operate smoothly, freely and without binding. The pivot mechanisms shall be sufficiently tight to ensure correct alignment of the tips with no free-play or overlap of the tips. The tip mating surfaces shall mate cleanly with no discernable gap at any point of the surfaces.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T20:15Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.4 Finish. The finish shall be satin as defined in Federal Specification GG-I-526.

3.5 Passivation. Forceps shall be properly passivated.

3.6 Resistance to Corrosion. Forceps shall show no signs of corrosion or plating of copper sulfate when tested as specified in 4.5.2.

3.7 Markings. Forceps shall be permanently marked with the manufacturer's name or registered trademark and the word "stainless." In addition, forceps of foreign manufacture shall bear the name of the country of manufacture.

3.8 Workmanship. The forceps shall be free from grind marks, burrs, and sharp edges. The finish shall be smooth and uniform. The forceps shall be free from any defects which affect the serviceability, utility, or service life.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Responsibility for compliance. All items must meet all requirements of sections 3 and 5. The inspection set forth in this specification shall become a part of the contractor's overall inspection system or quality program. The absence of any inspection requirements in the specification shall not relieve the contractor of the responsibility of assuring that all products or supplies submitted to the Government for acceptance comply with all requirements of the contract. Sampling in quality conformance does not authorize submission of known defective material, either indicated or actual, or does it commit the Government to acceptance of defective material.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202640-21T20:15Z
Check the source to verify that this is the currenversion before use.

4.1.2 Certificate of quality. Certificate of quality supplied by the manufacturer of the steel may be furnished in lieu of actual performance of composition testing by the contractor, provided lot identity has been maintained and can be demonstrated to the Government. The certificate shall include the name of the contractor, the contract number, the name of the manufacturer or supplier, the National Stock Number, the item identification, the lot number, the lot size, the sample size, the date of testing, the test method, individual test results, and the specification requirements.

4.2 Inspection. Inspection, as used in this specification, is defined as both examination (such as visual, auditory, etc. investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties), of the item.

4.2.1 Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government, upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of 3 years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

4.3 Quality conformance inspection. Sampling for quality conformance inspection shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as specified herein.

4.3.1 Examination. The unit of product for examination shall be one forceps. Sampling shall be in accordance with Table I. The same sample shall be used for visual examination for major and minor defects.

TABLE I. Sampling for examination

Examination	Inspection level	AQL (percent defective)
Dimensional	S-3	1.0
Visual		
Major defects	II	1.0
Minor defects	II	2.5

4.3.1.1 Dimensional examination. Examination of forceps shall be conducted to determine compliance with the dimensional requirements of this specification.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T20:15Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.3.1.2 Visual examination. Forceps shall be examined for the defects listed in Table II. Examination shall not, however, be limited to the defects in Table II.

TABLE II. Classification of defects

Categories	Defects
Critical	None defined
Major	
101	Finish not uniform or not free from rust or scale.
102	Burrs, pitting, or rough areas present.
103	Scratches or grind marks present.
104	Tips misaligned.
105	Pin not flush.
106	Operation not smooth.
107	Operation stiff.
108	Gap between tips when closed.
109	Lateral movement of finger-rings present.
Minor	
201	Forceps not clean.
202	Markings missing, illegible, or incorrect.

4.3.2 Tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as indicated in table III. The unit of product for test purposes shall be one forceps. Where feasible, the same sample unit shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

TABLE III. Sampling criteria for tests

Characteristic	Requirement	Test procedure	Inspection level	AQL (percent defective)
Hardness	3.2	4.4.2	S-2	1.0
Corrosion	3.6	4.4.3	S-1	1.0

4.4 Test Methods.

4.4.1 Composition test (see 4.1.2). A sufficient amount of raw material shall be tested as to be representative of the lot or batch. Acceptance number shall be zero (0). Any approved quantitative ASTM test method shall be used. Alternate methods may be acceptable if approved by DPSC.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-21T20:15Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.4.2 Hardness test. Hardness shall be measured in accordance with ASTM Standards E 18 or ASTM Standards E 92 and E140.

4.4.3 Corrosion resistance. Forceps shall be tested for resistance to copper sulfate and resistance to boil in accordance with GG-I-526.

4.4.4 Inspection of packaging. The sampling and inspection of the preservation and interior package marking shall be in accordance with groups A and B quality conformance inspection requirements of MIL-P-116. The sampling and inspection of the packing and marking for shipment and storage shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of the applicable container specification and the marking requirements of MIL-STD-129.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation. Preservation shall be level A or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Cleaning and drying. Forceps shall be cleaned and dried in accordance with MIL-P-116.

5.1.1.2 Preservative applications. Preservatives shall not be used.

5.1.1.3 Unit package. Each forceps shall be packaged in accordance with MIL-P-116, method IC-1 or IC-3.

5.1.1.4 Intermediate package. Six unit packages shall be packaged in a box conforming to PPP-B-566, PPP-B-636, class domestic or PPP-B-676. Closure shall be as specified in the applicable box specification.

5.1.2 Level C.

5.1.2.1 Unit package. Preservation for forceps shall conform to the MIL-STD-794 requirements for this level.

5.1.2.2 Intermediate package. Six unit packages shall be packaged in accordance with the requirements of MIL-STD-794 for level C.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B or C as specified (see 6.2).

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202640-21T20:15Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5.2.1 Level A. Twelve intermediate packages (72 units) shall be packed in an exterior container designed for a type 2 load and conforming to PPP-B-601, overseas type, PPP-B-621, class 2, or PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant. Closure and strapping shall be as specified in the applicable box specification.

5.2.2 Level B. Twelve intermediate packages (144 units) shall be packed in an exterior container designed for a type 2 load and conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. Closure shall be as specified in the box specification.

5.2.1.1 Case liner. Each level A wood box shall be lined with a waterproof case liner conforming to MIL-L-10547. Closure and sealing shall be as specified in the liner specification. Case liner shall not be required for fiberboard boxes. Each fiberboard box shall be waterproofed as specified in PPP-B-636.

5.2.2 Level B. Twelve intermediate packages (72 units) shall be packed in an exterior container designed for a type 2 load and conforming to PPP-B-601, domestic type, PPP-B-621, class 1, or PPP-B-636, class domestic. Closure shall be as specified in the applicable box specification.

5.2.3 Level C. Twelve intermediate packages (72 units) shall be packed in accordance with the requirements of MIL-STD-794 for level C.

5.2.4 Packing variation permitted. If the required number of units to be shipped is less than the number of units specified to be overpacked in a exterior container, such units shall be packed in an exterior container of suitable size and design, acceptable to a common carrier, which will insure safe delivery to destination.

5.2.5 Unitized loads. Unitized loads, commensurate with the level of packing specified in the contract or order, shall be used whenever total quantities for shipment to one destination equal 40 cubic feet or more. Loads shall be unitized on pallets conforming to MIL-STD-147. Quantities less than 40 cubic feet need not be unitized. Pallet loads including the pallet shall not exceed 43 inches in height, 48 inches in width, and 40 inches in length, and shall conform to Type IV or Type V.

5.2.5.1 Levels A, B. Forceps shall be packed as specified in 5.2.1 and 5.2.2 shall be unitized on pallets as specified in 5.2.5.

5.2.5.2 Level C. Forceps shall be packed as specified in 5.2.3 shall be unitized as specified in MIL-STD-794.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T20:15Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5.3. Marking.

5.3.1 Forceps. Each forceps shall be permanently marked as specified in 3.7.

5.3.2 Levels A, B, and C. Each unit pack, intermediate package, exterior container and unitized load shall be marked as specified in MIL-STD-129.

5.4 General.

5.4.1 Exterior container. Exterior container (see 5.2.1, 5.2.2, and 5.2.3) shall be of minimum tare and cube consistent with the protection required and shall contain equal quantities of identical stock numbered items to the greatest extent practicable.

5.4.2 Packaging inspection. The inspection of these packaging requirements shall be in accordance with 4.6.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The forceps are intended to implant a wire strut in the ear.

6.2 Ordering data.

6.2.1 Acquisition requirements. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(c) National Stock Number.

6.3 This specification is intended to cover the following items appearing in the Federal Supply Catalog:

National Stock No.	Item Identification
6515-01-139-8332	FORCEPS, EAR, House, Strut, Extremely Delicate

6.4 Subject term (key word) listing.

Ear implant
Ear strut applicator
Ear forceps

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T20:15Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing Activity:

DoD-MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
PHS
FDA-MPQAS

Project No. 6515-3678

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T20:15Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

INSTRUCTIONS: In a continuing effort to make our standardization documents better, the DoD provides this form for use in submitting comments and suggestions for improvements. All users of military standardization documents are invited to provide suggestions. This form may be detached, folded along the lines indicated, taped along the loose edge *(DO NOT STAPLE)*, and mailed. In block 5, be as specific as possible about particular problem areas such as wording which required interpretation, was too rigid, restrictive, loose, ambiguous, or was incompatible, and give proposed wording changes which would alleviate the problems. *Enter in block 6 any remarks not related to a specific paragraph of the document. If block 7 is filled out,* an acknowledgement will be mailed to you within 30 days to let you know that your comments were received and are being considered.

NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document*(s)* or to amend contractual requirements.

(Fold along this line)

(Fold along this line)

DEFENSE LOGISTICS AGENCY

NO POSTAGE NECESSARY IF MAILED IN THE UNITED STATES

OFFICIAL BUSINESS
PENALTY FOR PRIVATE USE $300

BUSINESS REPLY MAIL
FIRST CLASS PERMIT NO 4966 WASHINGTON D. C.
POSTAGE WILL BE PAID BY THE DEFENSE LOGISTICS AGENCY

Commander
Defense Personnel Support Center
Attn: DPSC-[illegible]STS
2800 South [illegible]th Street
Philadelphia, PA 19101

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202640-21T20:15Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
MIL-F-42032 (DM)	FORCEPS, EAR, House, Strut

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
	☐ USER
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

(TO DETACH THIS FORM, CUT ALONG THIS LINE.)

DD FORM 82 MAR 1426 PREVIOUS EDITION IS OBSOLETE.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202640-21T20:15Z
Check the source to verify that this is the currenversion before use.